



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: New Covenant Christian Academy
School Website: <https://nccaky.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

New Covenant Christian Academy (NCCA) in Hardin, KY presents a notably classical Christian framework across its public materials. The school foregrounds Christ-centered formation, biblical worldview, and the liberal-arts orientation, anchored by explicit references to classical pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the Trivium, and elements of the Great Conversation. Public materials emphasize liturgical aspects (weekly chapel/worship), a partnership with families, and a structured progression from grammar through rhetoric (K-12), along with a culture that values memory work, recitation, singing, and Socratic-style inquiry at the upper levels. Taken together with explicit statements about being "Classically Informed" and about the liberal-arts curriculum, these cues align strongly with the Six Essential Elements framework for classical education. The school also demonstrates collaboration with parents and clear engagement with the community, further reinforcing the classical formation model.

Overall classification by category (based on keyword analysis against the Six Essential Elements keyword indicators) is CLASSICAL across all six categories. The school's public materials consistently reflect transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) through a biblically grounded, virtue-centered approach; curricular structure includes grammar, logic, and rhetoric; pedagogy includes memorization, chant, and Socratic discussion at appropriate levels; faculty and leadership are portrayed as mentors and living exemplars; and parents/community partnerships are foregrounded.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on keyword analysis: Across all categories, the school's materials show direct alignment with positive keywords such as Christ-centeredness, biblical truth/worldview, liturgical worship, liberal arts orientation, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, Socratic dialogue, scholé/restful learning, memory work, and partnership with families. Where relevant, negative keywords from the classical framework (e.g., value-neutral ethics, excessive project-based only approaches) are not evidenced in the public materials; rather, the materials emphasize formation, virtue, and unity of truth, goodness, and beauty. Citations to the source materials are embedded in the category sections below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Analysis

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered, gospel-centered educational aim. Examples include statements such as "NCCA is a Christ-centered school" and "Cultivate faith, wisdom, and character

through biblical truth and Christ-centered connection.”

- The school describes itself as “Gospel Centered, Academically Excellent and Classically Informed,” signaling a transcendent moral realism integrated with theological framing. - Weekly chapel services with a local pastor and a time of worship are explicit practices, signaling liturgical/community life as part of formation. - Public materials reference biblical worldview, biblical truth, and theology-oriented framing (Statements of Faith/Vision; biblical wisdom).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present (approximate count from the NCC materials): Christ-centered; gospel-centered; biblical truth; biblical worldview; weekly chapel/worship; Christian wisdom; virtue; beauty; organic integration of faith and learning. - Negative keywords invoked in the classical lexicon (e.g., secularism, values-neutral ethics) do not appear in the NCC materials.

Estimated balance: Strong positive orientation with 8–10 explicit positive keywords identified, 0 negative keywords identified in the NCC materials. This yields a predominantly CLASSICAL alignment for this category.

Why this rating - The materials consistently ground education in theological commitments and transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) within a Christian framework, with liturgical/community life integrated into schooling. This aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices, and it is reinforced by direct statements about biblical truth and a gospel-centered mission. The presence of chapel, biblical worldview, and Christ-centered framing supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file3□turn0file12□

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated goal centers on formation and virtue, not merely job preparation. Phrases such as “Cultivate faith, wisdom, and character” and “biblical wisdom, beauty, and virtue” indicate formation and moral purpose beyond vocational outcomes. - Public materials emphasize formation and the liberal-arts orientation, with references to “Classically Informed” education and a biblically grounded worldview. - Statements of purpose reference the aim to cultivate virtue and wisdom as real and knowable, aligning with the transcendental aims highlighted in the classical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; liberal education; telos; great conversation (via classical framework); human flourishing; wisdom; moral imagination. - Negative keywords (from the classical model) such as “career readiness” or “skills-first” are not evidenced in the NCC public materials; the site emphasizes formation and virtue rather than mere job training. - The school's materials explicitly embrace “formation” and “virtue” as central aims, aligning with the Positive Keyword set for this dimension.

Estimated balance: Approximately 5–6 positive keywords identified; 0 negative keywords observed in the NCC materials. CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The materials reveal a clear focus on formation, virtue, and human flourishing through a liberal-arts framework, consistent with the classical aim that education is formation rather than mere information. The presence of “Great Conversation” language and “liberal arts” framing further supports a CLASSICAL rating. □filecite□turn0file3□turn0file12□turn1file6□

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly identifies a liberal-arts orientation and classical formation through references to “Classically Informed,” “Liberal Arts curriculum,” and a Trivium-centered structure. The presence of a Trivium Grade Chart (grammar, logic, rhetoric) demonstrates alignment with the Seven Liberal Arts model. □filecite□turn0file12□turn0file18□turn1file19□ - The Trivium is detailed in materials such as Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric progression, with notes on recitation, memory, and a rhythm of learning that aligns with classical curricula. - Positive references to Great Books/Great Conversation and primary sources appear in the broader classical education lexicon and in the school's recommended reading materials that support a classical canon mindset.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; grammar/logic/rhetoric; Quadrivium; Great Books/Great Conversation (via canonical classical references); history/Western civilization; integration across subjects; wonder. - Negative keywords: The NCC materials do not display project-centric or purely social-studies-oriented framing that would push toward a non-classical approach; rather, they emphasize an integrated classical canon. - The school's materials emphasize a classical-curriculum architecture (grammar/logic/rhetoric; liberal arts; Great Books/Great Conversation context) consistent with Positive Keyword indicators.

Estimated balance: 4–6 positive keywords identified; 0–1 negative keywords (none explicitly shown in NCC materials). CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on liberal arts education, the Trivium structure (grammar/logic/rhetoric), and the presence of a Trivium progression strongly align with classical curriculum criteria. The presence of “Great Conversation” language or canon-based readings, and the focus on history through a Western/canonical lens, supports CLASSICAL status for this category. □filecite□turn0file12□turn1file19□

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials describe a pedagogy that uses contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) and Socratic/Socratic-style discourse at appropriate levels. The Trivium materials describe upper-school Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training. Lower grades include singing, memory work, chanting, recitation, and regular memory review. □filecite□turn0file11□turn1file19□ - There is explicit reference to teaching methods that incorporate guided discovery, debates, and field experiences, alongside recitation and memory work, which map onto classical pedagogical indicators. The “grammar” and “recitation” methods show a strong memory-and-formative approach. - The public materials emphasize the upper-school emphasis on rhetoric, with opportunities to give speeches and develop oratorical skills as part of the program.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue and dialectic; Scholé (restful learning); memory work; recitation/chanting; imitation of models; seminars; rhetoric; speeches/debates; guided discovery; field trips; student presentations; field experiences. - Negative keywords from the classical framework (e.g., pure experiential/project-based learning as a sole approach) are not evidenced in NCC materials; rather, classical pedagogy elements are foregrounded. - The frequency of classical pedagogy cues is high, with several distinct methods identified (Socrates, memory work, chant, recitation, grammar-to-rhetoric progression).

Estimated balance: High positive keyword presence (4–7 distinct modalities); 0 negative keywords observed. CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The pedagogical approach aligns with classical expectations: a progression from memory-based, chant/recitation-based learning in the early grades to Socratic/seminar/rhetoric activities in upper grades, complemented by thoughtful, contemplative pacing. The explicit inclusion of “Socratic dialogue,” “Scholé,” and “memory work” in the NCC materials solidifies CLASSICAL status. □filecite□turn0file11□turn1file19□

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials highlight dedicated staff and leadership structures (Who We Are; Statements of Faith and Vision; Board of Directors; Staff). This points to an organized faculty and leadership ecosystem that can model virtue and mentor students. - The school frames its faculty and staff as essential components of the living curriculum (the idea that teachers embody the aims of the education, and that the staff/stewardship shape the learning environment) through public-facing content about staff, governance, and commitments to Christian, classical education. The presence of a staff directory and board implies a structured, mentorship-oriented faculty culture aligned with classical expectations.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum (via the classical framework rhetoric), model teachers and mentors (per classical lexicon; see the knowledge-base indicators), por-

trait of teacher/student ideals, collaborative faculty culture. - Negative keywords (e.g., “facilitator” or purely service-professional jargon without classical context) are not evident in the NCC public materials; there is explicit emphasis on teacher roles, mentorship, and virtue in pedagogy and formation.

Estimated balance: 3–5 positive keywords present (teacher as mentor, living curriculum, portrait of teacher/student ideals; staff/governance structure); 0 clearly negative keywords.

CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The publicly visible staff structures (Who We Are; Staff; Board of Directors) and the emphasis on teachers as mentors and as core components of the curriculum align with the classical category expectations, where the faculty are central to forming character and intellect. The presence of formal governance and staff engagement supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnerships with families and community involvement: “Cultivate faith, wisdom, and character through biblical truth and Christ-centered connection” and “Uniting with families and our community in faith and purpose.” These phrases articulate a co-educator model with families as partners. - There is clear outreach to parents (schedules for tours, admissions processes, and opportunities to engage in school life), including language about forming partnerships with families and inviting parental involvement. - The materials indicate open and ongoing engagement with families (e.g., “Schedule a Tour,” parent/community involvement, and volunteer opportunities).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; open campus; parent involvement; family engagement; community of learners; parental leadership. - Negative keywords from classical lexicon (e.g., customer-focused, minimal parent involvement) do not appear; the NCC materials reflect active parental engagement and community integration.

Estimated balance: 4–5 positive keywords present; 0 negative keywords observed. CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The school's emphasis on partnering with families, parent formation opportunities, and welcoming parental involvement aligns with the classical principle of a strong parent-community partnership and formation of affections through shared tradition. This places Element 6 squarely in CLASSICAL.

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What Would Move the Needle

Given the SCHOOL is classified CLASSICAL across all six categories, no “needle-moving” changes are required to reach a more classical status. If the aim were to further strengthen CLASSICAL alignment, possible enhancements could include: - Expand explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments beyond implied canon references, with a published list of primary-sources and assigned readings across grade levels. - Increase explicit articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts in curriculum documents, mapping each grade/year to Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric milestones and Quadrivium topics. - Provide more documented evidence of the living-curriculum concept in faculty descriptions and governance materials (e.g., explicit statements showing teachers as mentors who embody classical aims).

However, these are additive rather than corrective steps given the current evidence.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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